Coaching Codex



COACHING CODEX · GUIDE 09 · AI FOR SALES EMAILS

Follow-Up Without Fear

Follow up on quotes, quiet leads and past customers without feeling pushy: a 4-touch sequence, 12 scripts for email and messaging apps, and prompts that use only the facts in your records.

4	12	7
touch follow-up sequence	scripts for quotes, leads & win-backs	day follow-up plan

START HERE

Silence is not a no. It's usually just busy.

You sent a quote, a customer said "let me think about it", or a regular stopped booking. Then nothing. Following up can feel awkward, so many owners don't. This guide gives you a calm, polite routine: a few short messages at sensible gaps, each based on facts from your own records, drafted with AI and checked by you before you send.



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THE GOLDEN RULE

Every follow-up uses only **facts you can see in your own records**: what you quoted, when you sent it, the amount and what happens next. AI is good at making a message short, warm and clear. It is not a source of new discounts, deadlines or promises.

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SECTION 01 · WHY PEOPLE GO QUIET

Why people go quiet (it's rarely about you)

When a customer stops replying, it is tempting to assume they said no. Often they are simply busy, still comparing, or waiting on someone else. A good follow-up makes the next step easy, whatever the reason.

Common reason	What it can look like	What a follow-up can do
Busy	They meant to reply and forgot	A short reminder with the key details
Comparing	They asked several businesses for quotes	Answer a likely question, clearly
Waiting on someone	A partner, manager or budget decision	Offer something easy to forward
Unsure about a detail	Scope, timing or what's included	Invite one question
Not now	Timing changed on their side	Ask when to check back
No	They chose someone else	Close politely and leave the door open

PROMPT · THINK FROM THEIR SIDE

I sent a quote to a customer and haven't heard back. Here are the facts from my records: [WHAT I QUOTED, DATE SENT, AMOUNT, ANYTHING THEY SAID].
List 3 possible reasons they might not have replied yet, based only on these facts, and for each one suggest one short, friendly sentence I could include in a follow-up. Do not assume they said no. Do not suggest discounts or deadlines. If you need more information, ask me first.

EXERCISE 1 · YOUR OPEN QUOTES (10 MINUTES)

Check your sent folder and list every quote or proposal with no reply yet. Use a reference, not the customer's personal details.

Quote ref	What	Date sent	Next step

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SECTION 02 · YOUR FACTS

Your follow-up facts sheet

Most follow-up mistakes are factual: the wrong amount, an old date, a service they never asked for. Write the facts down once, from your records, before you open any AI tool.

1. Open the **original quote or email** in your sent folder or quoting tool.
2. Copy the **reference, service and amount** exactly, including the currency.
3. Note the **date you sent it** and how long the quote is valid, if you set a limit.
4. Write the **one next step** you want: a yes, a question, a call or a site visit.
5. Add anything **they told you**, such as "deciding after the holidays". Nothing guessed.

PROMPT · TURN MY NOTES INTO A FACTS SHEET

Here are my rough notes about a quote: [PASTE YOUR NOTES, NO CUSTOMER CONTACT DETAILS].
Organize them into a short facts sheet with these lines: quote reference, service, amount and currency, date sent, valid until, what the customer told me, next step I want.
Use only what is in my notes. If a line is missing or unclear, write [MISSING] and ask me for it. Do not fill gaps with guesses.

PRIVACY AND MESSAGING RULES

Don't paste customer names with contact details, addresses, phone numbers or payment information into an AI tool. A first name or "the customer" plus a quote reference is enough; add personal details yourself in your email or messaging app. Only follow up through a channel the customer used or agreed to, and stop when someone asks. Rules on marketing messages differ by country (for example CAN-SPAM in the US, and PECR and GDPR in the UK and EU). This is general information, not legal advice.

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SECTION 03 · THE SEQUENCE

The 4-touch sequence: day 2, 5, 10 and 30

Four short, polite touches, counted from the day you sent the quote. Each one is shorter than the last and has a different job. The gaps are estimates: adjust to your trade and to anything the customer told you.

Touch	Day (est.)	Its job	Script
1	Day 2	Check it arrived; invite questions	1
2	Day 5	Add one useful, true detail	2
3	Day 10	Ask about the decision, simply	3
4	Day 30	Close the loop kindly; door open	4

1. **Did it arrive?** Hi [FIRST NAME], just checking my quote [REF] for [SERVICE] reached you on [DATE]. Happy to answer any questions.
2. **One useful detail**: One thing I didn't mention: [TRUE, USEFUL DETAIL FROM YOUR RECORDS]. Does that help with your decision?
3. **Simple decision check**: Are you still thinking about [SERVICE], or has your plan changed? Either answer is completely fine.
4. **Close the loop**: I haven't heard back, so I'll assume the timing isn't right and close quote [REF] for now. If anything changes, just reply here.

SHORTER EVERY TIME

Touch 1 can be three sentences; touch 4 can be two. If the customer replies at any point, stop the sequence and answer them like a person. If they say "not now", ask when to check back and put that date in your calendar.

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SECTION 04 · DRAFT WITH AI

Build your whole sequence with one prompt

Give AI your facts sheet once and ask for all four touches. Then check each message against your records and save them as drafts, ready to send on the right day.

PROMPT · MY 4-TOUCH QUOTE FOLLOW-UP

I run [ABOUT YOUR BUSINESS]. I sent a quote and haven't heard back.
Facts from my records: quote [REF] for [SERVICE], [AMOUNT AND CURRENCY], sent on [DATE], valid until [DATE OR "NO LIMIT"]. What the customer told me: [ANYTHING THEY SAID OR "NOTHING"]. Next step I want: [NEXT STEP].
Write 4 short follow-ups in [LANGUAGE] for day 2, day 5, day 10 and day 30. Each shorter than the last, friendly, no guilt-tripping. Day 30 closes the loop politely.
Use only these facts and figures exactly as given. Do not add discounts, deadlines, stock or promises. If an essential fact is missing, ask me before drafting.

1. Paste the prompt with your facts filled in, and send it.
2. Read each draft next to your **original quote**: reference, amount, date.
3. Delete anything you didn't give the AI: a discount, a deadline, a claim.
4. Save the four messages as drafts or calendar reminders for their days.

EXERCISE 2 · PLAN ONE REAL SEQUENCE

Pick one open quote from Exercise 1. Count from the date you sent it and write the four send dates (write months as words, e.g. "March 3").

Touch 1 (day 2)	Touch 2 (day 5)	Touch 3 (day 10)	Touch 4 (day 30)

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SECTION 05 · MESSAGING APPS

WhatsApp and text versions: shorter and warmer

If a customer contacted you on WhatsApp or by text, a follow-up there can feel more natural than another email. Messages work best when they are very short and read like a person, not a template.

Email follow-up	Message follow-up
2–4 short sentences	1–2 sentences
Subject line with the reference	Reference in the first line
Signature with your business name	Your first name and business
Fine for detail and attachments	Link or say "I'll email the details"

5 **Quick nudge**: Hi [FIRST NAME], [YOUR NAME] from [BUSINESS] here. Did the quote for [SERVICE] come through OK?

6 **Easy question**: Any questions about the [SERVICE] quote? Happy to help by message or a quick call.

7 **Timing check**: No rush on the [SERVICE] quote. Should I check back in [MONTH], or would you rather I didn't?

PROMPT · EMAIL TO MESSAGE

Here is my follow-up email: [PASTE CHECKED EMAIL].
Rewrite it as a short [WHATSAPP / TEXT] message in [LANGUAGE], under 35 words, warm and plain, one question at the end, at most one emoji.
Keep the reference and every fact exactly as written. Do not add anything new. If the email has no clear question, ask me what next step I want.

ONLY WHERE THEY STARTED THE CONVERSATION

Use WhatsApp or text only if the customer contacted you there or agreed to it, and follow the messaging app's own business rules. One message per touch, sent at a reasonable local time. If they don't reply, don't double up across channels.

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SECTION 06 · LEADS AND WIN-BACKS

Cold leads and past customers (scripts 8–12)

The same calm approach works for people who asked about your service but never booked, and for past customers who haven't been back. Mention something real you share with them, then one easy question.

Cold leads: they asked, then went quiet

8 **After an inquiry**: You asked about [SERVICE] on [DATE]. Is that still something you're planning? Happy to answer questions.

9 **After a call or visit**: Thanks again for [CALL OR VISIT] on [DATE]. As promised, here's [WHAT YOU PROMISED]. What would help you decide?

Win-backs: past customers

10 **Friendly check-in**: It's been a while since [LAST SERVICE] in [MONTH]. How is [THING YOU HELPED WITH] going?

11 **Something new and true**: We now offer [NEW SERVICE OR HOURS]. Given [WHY IT FITS THEM], thought you might like to know.

12 **Seasonal reminder**: With [SEASON OR EVENT] coming up, would you like to book [SERVICE] again? Reply and I'll send available times.

PROMPT · WIN BACK A PAST CUSTOMER

I run [ABOUT YOUR BUSINESS]. Write a short, warm message in [LANGUAGE] to a past customer.
From my records: their last [SERVICE] was in [MONTH AND YEAR]. Something new and true, if any: [CONFIRMED NEWS OR "NOTHING"]. Next step I'd like: [NEXT STEP].
Under 60 words, one easy question, no pressure. Use only these facts. Do not mention discounts, offers or details I haven't listed. If something essential is missing, ask me first.

ONLY OFFERS YOU REALLY HAVE

A win-back works without a discount. If you do include an offer, copy its exact terms and end date from your own records, and check that the AI didn't change them.

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SECTION 07 · CHECK AND REPAIR

Check and repair before you send

Asking the AI "is this correct?" is not a check. Put the draft next to your original quote or customer record and compare it line by line. Then repair only what is wrong.

- [ ] Reference, service, amount, currency and dates match my records exactly
- [ ] No new discount, deadline, stock claim or promise was added
- [ ] Shorter than my last message, with one easy question or next step
- [ ] Friendly and calm: no guilt-tripping, no "just following up again!!"
- [ ] Right channel, right language, and I read it out loud before sending

Problem	Repair prompt
Wrong fact or figure	Replace this assumption with the following confirmed fact: [FACT]. Change nothing else.
Invented discount or deadline	Remove the [DISCOUNT / DEADLINE]. I did not offer it. Keep everything else.
Sounds pushy	Rewrite this in a relaxed, no-pressure tone. Keep the facts and the question.
Too long	Cut this to under [NUMBER] words. Keep the reference, date and question.

EXERCISE 3 · CATCH THE MISTAKE

Draft touch 1 for your quote from Exercise 2 with the prompt on page 6. Compare it with your records and write down anything you had to fix, and the repair prompt you used.

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SECTION 08 · HABIT

Your 7-day follow-up plan

Follow-up works best as a small routine, not a burst of guilt once a month. After the first week, keep the tracker going and review it every Friday.

Day	Action	Time (est.)	Done
1	List open quotes and quiet leads (Exercise 1)	20 min	
2	Write facts sheets for your top 3 quotes	20 min	
3	Draft and check 4-touch sequences for those quotes	30 min	
4	Send today's touches; make message versions if needed	15 min	
5	Pick 3 cold leads; draft and send scripts 8–9	20 min	
6	Pick 3 past customers; draft and send a win-back (10–12)	20 min	
7	Log replies; book check-back dates; plan next week	15 min	

Times are rough estimates and vary by business.

PROMPT · WEEKLY FOLLOW-UP REVIEW

This week I sent these follow-ups: [LIST: QUOTE REF, TOUCH NUMBER, CHANNEL].
What happened, from my own records: [REPLIES, BOOKINGS, NO REPLY, "NOT NOW"].
Suggest what to keep and what to change next week, using only these notes. Do not guess reasons I haven't given you; ask me instead.

Quote / lead ref	Sent	Touch 1	Touch 2	Touch 3	Touch 4	Outcome

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FIRST WIN · FICTIONAL EXAMPLE

Your first win, start to finish

Walk through a polite day-5 follow-up for Brightwater Plumbing, a made-up plumbing business in Columbus, Ohio, that quoted a made-up homeowner for a water heater replacement and heard nothing back. Nothing here is a real business, person or quote.

Example input	Value
Quote from my records	Q-2047: replace a 40-gallon water heater, USD 1,850 including parts and labor, sent on October 6, valid for 30 days
What the customer said	"Thanks, I'll talk it over with my partner."
Next step I want	Answer any questions, or book an install date
Tone and language	Friendly and calm, English

EXAMPLE COMPLETED PROMPT

Write a short, friendly follow-up email in English (under 70 words) from Dan at Brightwater Plumbing, a plumbing business in Columbus, Ohio.

Facts from my records: quote Q-2047 to replace a 40-gallon water heater, USD 1,850 including parts and labor, sent on October 6, valid for 30 days.
What the customer said: "Thanks, I'll talk it over with my partner."
Next step I want: answer any questions, or book an install date.

Include a subject line with the quote reference. Make it easy to forward to their partner, end with one easy question, and don't sound pushy. Use only these facts and figures exactly as given. Do not add discounts, deadlines, availability or warranty details. If an essential fact is missing, ask me before drafting.

Copy it, open your AI assistant (ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini or Copilot), paste and send. Then compare what you get with this:

ILLUSTRATIVE ANSWER, NOT A LIVE AI RESULT

Subject: your water heater quote (Q-2047) Hi, I hope the chat with your partner went well. Here's a quick recap to share: quote Q-2047 to replace your 40-gallon water heater, USD 1,850 including parts and labor, valid for 30 days from October 6. Any questions I can answer, or would you like to pick an install date? Dan, Brightwater Plumbing

Checks before use

- [ ] The reference, amount, what's included and the October 6 date match the quote exactly.
- [ ] No discount, deadline, availability or warranty promise was added.
- [ ] It ends with one easy question and doesn't guilt-trip.
- [ ] A human reads it out loud before it is sent.

USE IT

Copy the checked email, open your email app, reply in the same thread as the original quote, add your signature and send it yourself. The webpage does not send anything for you.

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GUIDED TASK

Follow up on a quote with no reply

When to use it: You sent a quote or proposal a few days ago and the customer hasn't replied. **Prepare:** The quote reference, service, amount and date, from your own records; Anything the customer told you; The one next step you want.

Question	Example answer
Describe your business in one sentence.	Brightwater Plumbing, a plumbing business in Columbus, Ohio (fictional)
What did you quote, for how much, and when?	Q-2047: replace a 40-gallon water heater, USD 1,850 including parts and labor, sent on October 6
Did the customer tell you anything?	"Thanks, I'll talk it over with my partner."
Which touch is this (day 2, 5, 10 or 30)?	Day 5: add one useful detail
Which language should the message be in?	English

PROMPT TEMPLATE

Write a short, friendly quote follow-up email (under 70 words) with a subject line that includes the quote reference.
About me: [ABOUT YOUR BUSINESS]
Quote from my records: [QUOTE + AMOUNT + DATE]
What the customer told me: [WHAT THEY SAID]
This is: [TOUCH]
Language: [LANGUAGE].
Keep it calm and easy to answer, end with one simple question, and don't guilt-trip. Use only these facts and figures exactly as given. Do not add discounts, deadlines, availability or promises. If an essential fact is missing, ask me before drafting.

ILLUSTRATIVE ANSWER, NOT A LIVE AI RESULT

Subject: water heater quote Q-2047 Hi, A quick recap you can share with your partner: quote Q-2047 to replace your 40-gallon water heater, USD 1,850 including parts and labor, sent on October 6. Any questions I can answer? Dan, Brightwater Plumbing

Checks before use

- [ ] The reference, amount, currency and date match your records exactly.
- [ ] No new discount, deadline or promise was added.
- [ ] It is short and ends with one easy question.
- [ ] It sounds calm, not pushy.

Repairs

If...	Send this
Wrong figure or date	“Replace this assumption with the following confirmed fact: [FACT]. Change nothing else.”
Invented discount or deadline	“Remove the [DISCOUNT / DEADLINE]. I did not offer it. Keep everything else.”
Sounds pushy	“Rewrite this in a relaxed, no-pressure tone. Keep the facts and the question.”

Next action: Reply in the same email thread as the quote, send it yourself, and put the next touch date in your calendar. Stop the sequence as soon as they reply.

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GUIDED TASK

Re-open a lead that went quiet

When to use it: Someone asked about your service or had a call with you, then stopped replying. **Prepare:** What they asked about and the date; Anything you promised to send them; The one next step you want.

Question	Example answer
Describe your business in one sentence.	Atelier Rive, a small interior design studio in Lyon (fictional)
What did they ask about, and when?	A kitchen redesign; we had a video call on September 12
Did you promise to send anything?	Three example kitchen layouts from past projects
What is the one next step you want?	A 15-minute call to agree a budget range
Which language should the message be in?	English

PROMPT TEMPLATE

Write a short, warm message (under 60 words) to re-open a conversation with a lead who went quiet.
About me: [ABOUT YOUR BUSINESS]
What they asked about and when: [WHAT + DATE]
What I promised to send: [WHAT YOU PROMISED]
Next step I want: [NEXT STEP]
Language: [LANGUAGE].
No pressure, easy to say "not now", one simple question at the end. Use only these facts. Do not invent prices, results or details of past projects. If something essential is missing, ask me before drafting.

ILLUSTRATIVE ANSWER, NOT A LIVE AI RESULT

Hi, Thanks again for our call on September 12 about your kitchen redesign. As promised, I've attached three example layouts from past projects. Would a 15-minute call to agree a budget range be helpful? If now isn't the right time, that's completely fine. Atelier Rive

Checks before use

- [ ] The date and topic match your notes or inbox.
- [ ] Anything mentioned as attached really is attached.
- [ ] No prices, results or project claims were added.
- [ ] It's easy to say "not now".

Repairs

If...	Send this
Wrong date or topic	“Replace this assumption with the following confirmed fact: [FACT]. Change nothing else.”
Added a claim	“Remove the sentence about [CLAIM]. Keep everything else.”
Too formal	“Make this sound like a friendly note from a person. Keep the facts and the question.”

Next action: Attach anything you promised, send it yourself in the original thread, and note a check-back date. If they say "not now", ask when to try again.

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GUIDED TASK

Win back a past customer

When to use it: A customer used to book or buy from you but hasn't been back for a while. **Prepare:** Their last booking or purchase and the month, from your records; Anything new and true at your business; The one next step you want.

Question	Example answer
Describe your business in one sentence.	Fern & Fur, a small dog grooming salon in Leeds (fictional)
What did they last book or buy, and when?	A full groom for their spaniel, Bramble, in June
Is there anything new and true to mention?	We now open on Saturday mornings
What is the one next step you want?	Reply to get our available times
Which language should the message be in?	English

PROMPT TEMPLATE

Write a short, warm win-back message (under 60 words) to a past customer.
About me: [ABOUT YOUR BUSINESS]
Their last booking from my records: [LAST BOOKING + MONTH]
Something new and true: [CONFIRMED NEWS]
Next step I want: [NEXT STEP]
Language: [LANGUAGE].
Friendly, no guilt-tripping, one easy question at the end. Use only these facts. Do not mention discounts, offers or details I haven't listed. If something essential is missing, ask me before drafting.

ILLUSTRATIVE ANSWER, NOT A LIVE AI RESULT

Hi! It's been a while since Bramble's full groom in June, and we hope she's doing well. News from us: we now open on Saturday mornings. Would you like me to send a few available times? Fern & Fur

Checks before use

- [ ] The last booking and month match your records.
- [ ] No discount or offer was added.
- [ ] It's warm, short and ends with one easy question.
- [ ] You're contacting them through a channel they agreed to.

Repairs

If...	Send this
Wrong detail	“Replace this assumption with the following confirmed fact: [FACT]. Change nothing else.”
Invented offer	“Remove the [OFFER]. I am not offering it. Keep everything else.”
Too long	“Cut this to under [NUMBER] words. Keep the last booking, the news and the question.”

Next action: Send it yourself through the channel they used with you before, and book any reply straight into your calendar. Try a seasonal reminder (script 12) in a few months if there's no reply.

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WHAT'S NEXT

Follow up calmly. Close more of what you quote.

Facts from your records, a few short touches at sensible gaps, and a human check before every send: that's a follow-up routine you can keep up without fear.

AI Sales Emails That Get Replies: 25 Templates & Prompts
Write the first email that starts the conversation.

Admin on Autopilot: Proposals, Quotes & Paperwork with AI
Send clearer quotes that need less follow-up.

Automate Your Inbox and Customer Replies with AI
Handle the replies your follow-ups bring in.

AI for Invoices, Expenses & Cash-Flow Basics
Polite payment reminders and simple cash-flow habits.

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